Day 58 (stop 1 of 2) - Harrison Park, Palisades, Creamery Hill

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Sydenham section · hike 73 · Harrison Park & the Palisades, Owen Sound

7.4 km / 4.6 mi	~2.4 h	3.6 km new	151 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

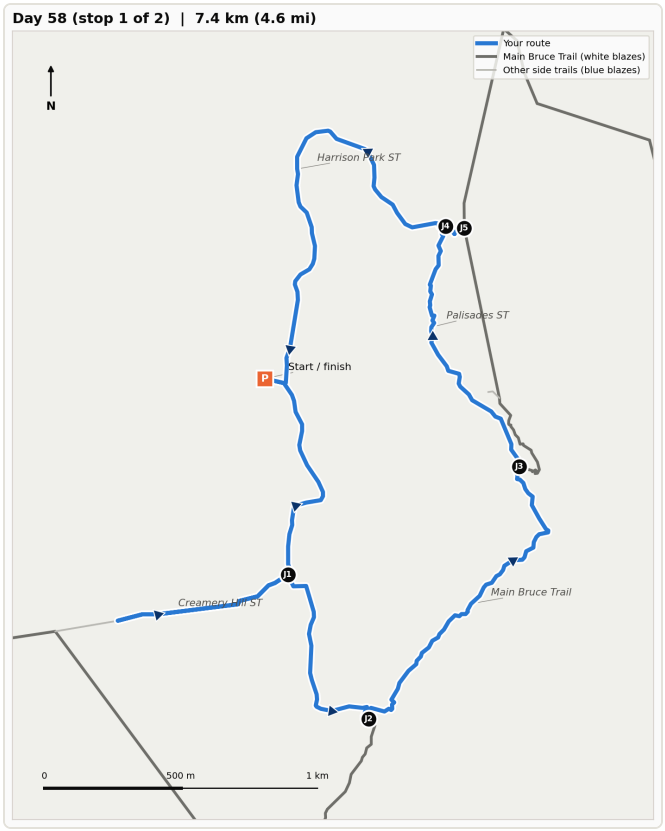
Park: Harrison Park: Excellent free parking in Harrison Park in several places. One example would be to drive east past the restaurant, over the bridge and immediately turn left into a parking area. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day58a_hike073.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Harrison Park Side Trail (1.8 km); Palisades Side Trail (1.1 km); Creamery Hill Side Trail (0.7 km)

Same day: this is stop 1 of 2 on day 58 (8.0 mi of hiking, about 310 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 2: hike 74, 3.3 mi from Grey-Bruce Tourist Information Office.

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Free parking in several places in Harrison Park. The park also has a year-round restaurant (Harrison Park Inn) and a campground.
- **Harrison Park Side Trail:** Easy walking on wide, hard-packed paths through hardwood forest and parkland along the Sydenham River. It passes the Black History Cairn and a boardwalk view of Weaver's Creek falls. The falls are on private land, so view them from the boardwalk.
- **Palisades Side Trail:** Moderate to difficult, with rugged, rocky uphill sections. It climbs the lower talus of the escarpment through a canyon with cliffs on both sides and fern glens, past the Devil's Playhouse, a rock overhang behind an easy-to-miss, unmarked narrow opening in the cliff.
- **Raven's Nest:** A very short side trail up to a lookout at the top of the escarpment. Keep Zappy close near the edge.
- **Creamery Hill Side Trail:** Includes two road-shoulder stretches. Keep Zappy close on the road. We found little published detail on its terrain.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Harrison Park: Excellent free parking in Harrison Park in several places. Walk about 100 m to the trail. Head south-east on the blue-blazed Harrison Park Side Trail.
0.9	0.6	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Creamery Hill Side Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed Harrison Park Side Trail goes off ahead.)
1.1	0.7	Heads-up: The next 0.4 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
2.2	1.4	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Harrison Park Side Trail, heading south-east. (the Harrison Park Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
3.0	1.9	J2: Turn sharp left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
4.4	2.7	J3: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Palisades Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
5.5	3.4	J4: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Harrison Park Side Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Harrison Park Side Trail goes off on your left.) There is trailhead parking here (Roadside parking on the shoulder of 7th Ave E, where the Harrison Park Side Trail enters...).

5.6	3.5	J5: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
5.7	3.5	J4: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Harrison Park Side Trail, heading west. (the Palisades Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.) There is trailhead parking here (Roadside parking on the shoulder of 7th Ave E, where the Harrison Park Side Trail enters...).
7.4	4.6	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Owen Sound Tourism and the Sydenham Bruce Trail Club.